Unit 1



OXYGEN ADMINISTRATION

Definition:

Oxygen therapy is the administration of oxygen to patients those who are suffering with respiratory dysfunction and low level of O_2 in blood.

Oxygen cylinder:

1. Oxygen is a gas, which has no smell or colour and is heavier than air
2. It is stored at high pressure in black and white colour cylinders
3. With oxygen there is always a serious fire risk
4. Smoking is not allowed anywhere nearby oxygen cylinder
5. No open fire or any inflammable material should be kept near the oxygen cylinder
6. Oil, grease or alcohol should never be used on the connections of the cylinder
7. The cylinder is mounted on a stand for easy access and should be tested before taking it to the bedside
8. To test it, open the cylinder with the key and then open the valve very little and test the flow of oxygen from the cylinder into a bottle half filled with water. (humidifier)
9. The humidifier bottle is connected with flow meter to know the amount of O_2 being delivered.
10. Oxygen flows into the humidifier and then oxygen is given to the patient



Indications for oxygen Administration:

- Cyanosis (bluish colour of the skin, nail beds and mucus membranes)
- Breathlessness or labored breathing
- An environment low in oxygen content. e.g. High altitudes
- Anaemia
- Diseases or conditions in the oxygen across the capillary membrane
- Shock and circulatory failure
- Haemorrhage and asphyxia
- Critically ill patients

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